Seven Thousand in Sight

S&P +1.17% to 6,967. Nasdaq rises a tenth straight day. Core PPI cools to +0.1%. IMF cuts 2026 global growth to 3.1%.

THE SESSION

The S&P 500 rose 1.17% to 6,967, pressing within reach of the 7,000 level for the first time since the Iran conflict began in late February. The Nasdaq added 1.96% for its tenth consecutive advancing session, its longest such streak since 2021. The Dow gained 0.66%. The Russell 2000 rose 1.32%. The VIX declined 3.87% to 18.38, continuing the steady compression of implied volatility that has characterized this rally.

The session absorbed two substantial macro inputs and digested them constructively. March PPI came in at +0.5% month-over-month, well below the +1.1% consensus estimate. Core PPI rose just 0.1% against expectations for 0.5%. The headline number confirmed that energy is driving the pipeline inflation—gasoline surged 15.7%, diesel 42%—but services costs were flat and core pressures remain contained. The market read it as a favorable pass-through story: the energy shock is real but narrower than feared.

Separately, the IMF published its World Economic Outlook, cutting 2026 global growth to 3.1% from 3.3% in January. The fund warned that the world is drifting toward its adverse scenario, in which oil prices persist near $100 and growth drops to 2.5%. U.S. growth was trimmed only marginally to 2.3%, reflecting the net energy exporter advantage. The market chose the PPI print over the IMF warning, continuing to price a short-lived conflict and a second-half normalization.

Bank earnings were mixed. JPMorgan beat but lowered net interest income guidance and slipped 1%. Wells Fargo missed on revenue and credit quality, falling 5%. BlackRock climbed 4% on strong results. Johnson & Johnson beat estimates and raised full-year guidance. The early Q1 reads suggest corporate earnings remain resilient even as the macro backdrop has shifted.

IOWN Tactical: The morning brief flagged Carson's major resistance at SPY $691.90–$693.20 as Tuesday's focal point. SPY closed above that zone, resolving the test to the upside. The S&P's push toward 7,000 now faces clear air above the pre-war technical structure. Positioning remains the tailwind—underweight accounts are chasing this rally. Stay the course.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

HOOD +10.35% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Led the entire portfolio on bullish analyst sentiment and anticipation of Q1 earnings on April 28. Bernstein reiterated Outperform, projecting $130 year-end target on crypto and prediction-market revenue growth. Pinwheel banking partnership added incremental positive flow.

BKH +6.14% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Hit a new 52-week high at $77.25 as the NorthWestern Energy merger approval advances. The combined Bright Horizon Energy entity creates a diversified eight-state utility with a 56-year dividend increase streak and a 3 GW data center pipeline.

COIN +5.66% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Continued the digital-asset leadership theme from Monday. Bitcoin held above $74,000 on renewed US-Iran negotiation hopes. Coinbase benefits from the broader crypto recovery and elevated trading volumes heading into Q1 reporting.

NVDA +3.80% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Extended the semiconductor rally as the peace trade accelerated rotation into growth. Report of potential acquisition talks added speculative flow. The stock remains 7% below its 52-week high, suggesting room to recapture pre-war levels.

AMD +3.34% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Rose alongside the broader chip complex. The $60B Meta infrastructure deal continues to reshape the competitive narrative, validating AMD as a genuine second-source for hyperscale AI compute.

DECLINERS

VLO –2.69% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Gave back Monday's blockade premium as oil retreated. Brent fell toward $96, unwinding the supply-shock trade. The energy sleeve is transitioning from war-premium expansion to structural-disruption persistence.

FAST –2.58% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Extended its post-earnings decline. Monday's narrow Q1 miss and flat growth guidance continue to weigh. The stock reflects caution on the industrial cycle amid elevated input costs and deferred customer capital spending.

CVX –2.48% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Fell alongside crude as renewed negotiation hopes pulled risk premium out of oil. Cramer reiterated a positive view on Chevron's operating quality, but the near-term trade is directionally tied to Brent.

PCAR –1.53% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Declined on diesel cost pass-through concerns. US truckers' diesel spending hit a record high per Reuters, pressuring fleet economics and the broader heavy-truck replacement cycle.

LMT –1.31% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Pulled back modestly as the defense sector rotated lower on peace-talk optimism. The blockade remains active, but the market is pricing a shorter conflict duration, which compresses the defense premium.

HOLDINGS NEWS

ABT earnings Thursday. Abbott Laboratories reports Q1 on April 16 with pre-announced guidance of $1.12–$1.18 per share, bracketing the $1.15 consensus. The print matters for diagnostic-sector read-through to DGX. Watch for guidance commentary on the energy cost pass-through environment.

QCOM deepens Bosch partnership. Qualcomm and Bosch announced an expanded long-term collaboration on automotive and industrial semiconductor applications. QCOM rose 1.22% on the session. The partnership extends Qualcomm's reach beyond mobile into the connected-vehicle ecosystem.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

+0.08%

vs. DVY –0.12% | IWS +0.35%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

+1.30%

vs. IUSG +2.02%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +9.42% vs DVY +7.83% / IWS +8.93%
Growth +4.87% vs IUSG +1.70%